

COGNITIVE BEHAVIORAL THERAPY (CBT) – SESSION 3

Reviewing Homework, Worry Management & Continuing Cognitive Work

Fictional Educational Example — Full Detailed

SESSION INFORMATION

Client: RK (35 y/o Male)
Session #: 3 of 16

Therapist: Dr. A.
Focus: Homework review + Worry management + Cognitive restructuring

PRE-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

Client brought completed thought records and attempted the behavioral experiment (deliberately stopping over-checking after a timer). He reported moderate success with the experiment but still struggled with worry at night. Today's focus: Review homework in detail, introduce "Worry Time" technique, continue challenging the perfectionistic belief, and assign integrated homework.

SESSION START & HOMEWORK REVIEW

Therapist: Good morning, RK. How was your week overall? Let's start by looking at the homework you brought.

Client: It was mixed. Some days were better, especially after I tried the timer experiment. But I still had two nights where I worried until late.

Therapist: That's useful feedback. Let's go through one of your thought records together.

(They review a thought record from a difficult evening. Therapist praises effort and helps client see how writing down evidence helped reduce belief in the thought from 80% to 55%.)

REVIEW OF BEHAVIORAL EXPERIMENT

Therapist: You also tried stopping the over-checking after setting a timer. How did that go?

Client: It was hard at first, but I managed to stop after 45 minutes instead of 2 hours. The next day the presentation went fine even though I didn't check everything 10 times. I felt a bit proud.

Therapist: That's excellent progress. What did you learn from this experiment?

Client: That I don't actually need to check everything endlessly. The world didn't end when I stopped early.

Therapist: Perfect. This is exactly how behavioral experiments work — they give us real evidence that challenges our old beliefs.

INTRODUCING THE "WORRY TIME" TECHNIQUE

Therapist: One technique that helps many people with generalized worry is called **"Worry Time"**. The idea is to schedule a specific 15–20 minute period each day (ideally not right before bed) where you allow yourself to worry. Outside that time, when a worry comes up, you write it down briefly and tell yourself "I'll deal with this during Worry Time" and then postpone it.

Client: That sounds interesting. I usually try to push worries away all day and then they explode at night.

Therapist: Exactly. By postponing them to a specific time, you reduce the constant background worry during the day and also train your brain that not every worry needs immediate attention. Would you like to try this for the next week?

Client: Yes, I'll try it. Maybe 8–8:20 PM every day?

CONTINUING COGNITIVE RESTRUCTURING

Therapist: Last session we worked on the thought "I have to be perfect or they will see I'm not good enough." You came up with a balanced thought. How much do you believe the original thought now compared to last week?

Client: It's down to about 60% now. The timer experiment helped a lot.

Therapist: Great movement. Let's strengthen this further. What would you say to a close colleague or friend who had the same thought after making a small mistake?

Client: I would tell them that one mistake doesn't define their whole ability. Everyone makes mistakes sometimes.

Therapist: That's a very compassionate and realistic perspective. How would it feel if you could apply that same kindness to yourself?

Client: It would feel much lighter. I'm going to try reminding myself of that.

HOMEWORK ASSIGNMENT

Therapist: For this week:

1. Continue the daily thought/mood diary
2. Practice **"Worry Time"** every day (15–20 minutes at a fixed time). Write down worries that come up during the day and postpone them to Worry Time.
3. Continue using the balanced thought we developed and rate your belief in the old thought each time it appears.
4. Try one more behavioral experiment: In one meeting this week, deliberately share one idea without over-preparing it first.

SESSION SUMMARY & FEEDBACK

Therapist: Today we reviewed your experiments and thought records, introduced the Worry Time technique, and continued strengthening your new balanced thinking. What felt most helpful?

Client: The Worry Time idea makes sense. And seeing that the timer experiment actually worked gave me more confidence.

Therapist: Excellent. Any questions before we finish?

Client: No, I'm clear on the homework.

POST-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

- Client showed good engagement with homework and was able to see the value of the behavioral experiment.
- Worry Time technique introduced and client is motivated to try it.
- Continued progress on reducing belief in perfectionistic thought (from 80% → 60%).
- New behavioral experiment planned for this week.
- Next session: Review Worry Time practice, continue cognitive work on core beliefs, introduce problem-solving skills if time permits.

Disclaimer: This is a completely fictional but realistic simulation created solely for educational and AI training purposes. It does not represent any real person or therapy.